

CLASS :
EXAM NO :

TIME : 3 Hrs
MARKS : 80

SECTION – A READING SKILLS (26 MARKS)

Answer ANY ONE of the following:

[Unseen Passage]

The relationship between grandparents and grandchildren is unique and irreplaceable. In today's fast-paced world, where nuclear families are becoming the norm, this bond often gets diluted. However, those fortunate enough to grow up with grandparents understand the treasure trove of wisdom, stories, and unconditional love they provide. Grandparents serve as a bridge between the past and present, carrying forward traditions, values, and family histories that might otherwise be lost. They offer a different perspective on life, shaped by decades of experience and the patience that comes with age. Unlike parents, who are often caught up in the daily struggles of providing and disciplining, grandparents can afford to be more indulgent and understanding. This creates a safe space for children to express themselves freely. Moreover, grandparents play a crucial role in child development. Studies have shown that children who have strong relationships with their grandparents tend to have better social skills, higher self-esteem, and greater emotional resilience. They learn empathy, respect for elders, and the importance of family bonds. The stories grandparents tell, whether from mythology, history, or their own lives, help develop imagination and cultural awareness in children. In many cultures, grandparents are the primary caregivers while parents work, ensuring that children grow up in a loving, stable environment. However, modernization and urbanization have created physical and emotional distances between generations. It is essential to make conscious efforts to maintain these precious relationships through regular visits, video calls, and shared activities. The wisdom of grandparents is not just about the past; it's about understanding life's continuity and finding our place in the larger narrative of family and society.

- (1) What makes the relationship between grandparents and grandchildren unique according to the passage? (2 marks)
- (2) How do grandparents serve as a bridge between past and present? (2 marks)
- (3) What advantages do grandparents have over parents in their relationship with children? (2 marks)
- (4) List any three benefits that children gain from strong relationships with their grandparents. (3 marks)
- (5) How has modernization affected the grandparent-grandchild relationship? (2 marks)
- (6) What conscious efforts does the passage suggest to maintain relationships between generations? (2 marks)
- (7) Find words from the passage which mean: (a) weakened (b) generous (2 marks)
- (8) Why is the wisdom of grandparents important for understanding life's continuity? (3 marks)

[Case Based Passage]

Green Valley School conducted a survey among 500 students to understand their reading habits and preferences. The survey revealed interesting patterns about how digital technology has influenced reading among teenagers. 65% of students reported reading primarily on digital devices, while 35% still preferred physical books. Among digital readers, 40% used smartphones, 35% used tablets, and 25% used e-readers or laptops. The survey also examined reading frequency: 20% read daily, 35% read 3-4 times a week, 30% read once a week, and 15% read less frequently. Genre preferences showed that 30% preferred fiction, 25% enjoyed non-fiction, 20% liked graphic novels, 15% read poetry, and 10% preferred newspapers and magazines. The most significant finding was the correlation between reading medium and comprehension. Students who read physical books reported 80% retention rate, while digital readers reported 60% retention. However, digital readers accessed 50% more content than physical book readers. The survey also revealed that 70% of students felt that social media had reduced their attention span for long-form reading. Despite this, 85% acknowledged the importance of reading for academic success and personal growth. The school library reported a 30% decrease in book borrowing over the past three years, while the digital library usage increased by 200%. Teachers expressed concern about declining deep reading skills but appreciated the accessibility that digital platforms provided.

- (1) What percentage of students preferred physical books over digital devices? (2 marks)
- (2) Among digital readers, which device was most commonly used for reading? (2 marks)
- (3) What was the difference in retention rates between physical book readers and digital readers? (2 marks)
- (4) How has social media affected students' reading habits according to the survey? (3 marks)
- (5) What contrasting trends were observed in the school library and digital library usage? (3 marks)
- (6) What were the top two genre preferences among students? (2 marks)
- (7) Despite accessing more content, why might digital reading be less effective than physical reading? (2 marks)
- (8) What percentage of students recognized the importance of reading for their development? (2 marks)

Based on passage:

Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to understand, use, and manage emotions effectively. It encompasses self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills. People with high EI can recognize their own emotions and those of others, using this awareness to guide thinking and behavior. Self-awareness involves understanding one's strengths, weaknesses, values, and impact on others. Self-regulation refers to managing disruptive emotions and adapting to change. Motivation in EI context means being driven by internal rewards rather than external factors. Empathy allows understanding others' emotions and perspectives, crucial for building relationships. Social skills include communication, conflict management, and leadership abilities. Research shows that EI is a better predictor of success than IQ in many fields. In the workplace, employees with high EI are better team players, handle stress effectively, and demonstrate superior leadership qualities. They can navigate office politics, resolve conflicts constructively, and maintain positive relationships with colleagues. In education, students with developed EI show better academic performance, fewer behavioral problems, and improved mental health. They can manage exam stress, work collaboratively, and maintain focus on long-term goals. EI can be developed through practice, mindfulness, active listening, and seeking feedback. Regular self-reflection, journaling, and meditation enhance emotional awareness. Reading literature and engaging

in diverse social interactions broaden emotional understanding. Unlike IQ, which remains relatively fixed, EI can be improved throughout life, making it a valuable skill for personal and professional development.

Write a summary of the above passage in about 80 words.

SECTION – B GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING (23 MARKS)

4. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words:

Rearrange the following words/phrases to form meaningful sentences:

- (a) relationship / my grandmother / the / changed / with / city / to / when / moved / we / the
- (b) scriptures / disturbed / teaching / was / she / about / no / there / that / was
- (c) sparrows / the / bread / would / courtyard / she / in / feed / the

You are the Secretary of the Senior Citizens' Welfare Association. Draft an advertisement in not more than 50 words for a 'Grandparents Day Celebration' inviting families to participate in various activities and competitions.

Design a poster in not more than 50 words for your school library promoting the importance of reading physical books in the digital age.

You are Rahul/Rashmi, Head Boy/Head Girl of your school. Write a speech in 120-150 words on 'The Role of Grandparents in Shaping Our Values' to be delivered on Grandparents Day.

Write a debate in 120-150 words either for or against the motion: 'Modern education system has lost touch with traditional values and moral teachings'.

SECTION – C LITERATURE (31 MARKS)

Read the extract:

The cardboard shows me how it was
When the two girl cousins went paddling,
Each one holding one of my mother's hands,
And she the big girl — some twelve years or so.

- (1) (a) What does 'the cardboard' refer to?
- (2) (b) Who are the 'two girl cousins'?
- (3) (c) What activity is being described in these lines?

Read the extract:

My grandmother and I were good friends. My parents left me with her when they went to live in the city and we were constantly together. She used to wake me up in the morning and get me ready for school. She said her morning prayer in a monotonous sing-song while she bathed and dressed me in the hope that I would listen and get to know it by heart.

- (1) (a) Why were the narrator and his grandmother constantly together?
- (2) (b) What did the grandmother do while getting the narrator ready?
- (3) (c) What was the grandmother's hope?

Read the extract:

We had sailed past our destination. The first indication of impending disaster came at about 6 p.m., with an ominous silence. The wind dropped, and the sky immediately grew dark. Then came a growing roar, and an enormous cloud towered aft of the ship. With horror, I realised that it was not a cloud, but a wave like no other I had ever seen. It appeared perfectly vertical and almost twice the height of the other waves, with a frightful breaking crest.

- (1) (a) What was the first indication of the impending disaster?
- (2) (b) What did the narrator initially mistake the wave for?
- (3) (c) Describe the appearance of the wave.
- (4) (d) What emotion did the narrator experience upon seeing the wave?

13. How did the grandmother spend her time when the narrator went up to university? (The Portrait of a Lady)

14. Describe the relationship between the narrator and his grandmother during the village school days. (The Portrait of a Lady)

15. How did the children show courage during the disaster at sea? (We're Not Afraid to Die...)

Answer ANY ONE of the following in 120-150 words:

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SUMMARY OF PAPER GENERATION

Section A: Reading Skills | Total Marks: 26

Section B: Grammar and Creative Writing | Total Marks: 23

Section C: Literature | Total Marks: 31